

Industry News

Worldwide semiconductor revenue to grow 27 per cent

Gartner forecasts that worldwide semiconductor revenues in 2010 will reach \$290 billion in 2010—a 27 per cent increase from 2009 revenue of \$228 billion. PCs and mobile phones will account for about 40 per cent of the semiconductor market growth.

The outlook for the semiconductor industry has improved from Gartner's first-quarter 2010 forecast, when it projected worldwide semiconductor sales to grow 19.9 per cent. Analysts said this improvement in market conditions is in part due to an accelerated broad-based recovery in all regions and most product categories.

Technology market to consolidate

According to market analysts, the technology industry is poised to move towards consolidation via the merger and acquisition route. Andy West, a principal in McKinsey & Co's merger management practice, predicted a coming wave of acquisitions and added, "Cross-segment acquisitions, such as a storage firm buying a networking company, are most likely."

Hewlett-Packard's \$13.9-billion acquisition of Electronic Data Systems in late-August 2008 was one of the last big tech mergers to close before the latest recession fully arrived. Dell followed by agreeing to buy Perot Systems Corp. for \$3.9 billion and Xerox agreed to buy Affiliated Computer Services Inc. for \$6.4 billion. And in April this year, HP inked a deal to buy networking firm 3Com Corp. for \$2.7 billion.

Telecom and IT to drive Indian semiconductor market

The semiconductor market in India grew 15.6 per cent in 2009 in contrast

APC appoints president, Asia Pacific and Japan

APC by Schneider Electric has appointed Philippe Arsonneau as president, Asia Pacific and Japan. In this role, Arsonneau is responsible for the business strategy, growth and development in Japan, Pacific, South East Asia, India and Korea, ensuring that APC by Schneider Electric across these regions remains focused on customers and partners. He will lead the team in developing customer-oriented processes, delivering innovative energy-efficient solutions in data centres and building successful relationships

as part of Schneider Electric.

Pitroda to head 'Smart Grid Task Force'

Sam Pitroda, advisor to the prime minister on public information infrastructure and innovation, will be the head of the India Smart Grid Task Force. The task force was set up to evolve a roadmap for development and deployment of smart and intelligent grid technologies with the aim of making India a world leader in this sphere. It is hoped that the smart grid will bring together communications, IT and power technologies and establish a comprehensive power infrastructure.

to the global market that shrunk by 11 per cent from 2008, says an ISA-Frost & Sullivan report. Wireless handsets, 3G networks, WiMax, notebooks, set-top boxes and smart cards are expected to primarily drive the semiconductor market in India. According to the report, telecommunications infrastructure development related domestic semiconductor consumption will grow by a massive 132.5 per cent from 2009 to 2011.

Buoyed by demand from telecom and IT sectors, the total semiconductor market is poised to grow from \$5.39 billion in 2009 to \$8.04 billion in 2011, at a CAGR of 22.1 per cent. The corresponding period is expected to witness a phenomenal CAGR of 34.8 per cent in the total semiconductor available

market (TAM). TAM revenue is anticipated to climb to \$4.84 billion in 2011 from \$2.66 in 2009.

Foreign solar firms eye Indian market

A large number of firms from Asia, Europe and North America are eyeing India's solar market, as India commits to an ambitious \$70-billion programme to build 20 gigawatts (GW) of solar capacity by 2022. Market analysts estimate huge opportunities for foreign firms such as Suntech and First Solar, which

